

5.4 Desi Variants

BigAdda, Fropper and Yaari are the three online social networking services we cover next. BigAdda, as the name suggests, is a site which gives you your own “adda” on the Web. For those not familiar with the term, adda means a hangout—a place where you meet your friends, chill out and have fun. Precisely, the tea stall outside your college, where buddies catch up on some hot and spicy gossip! Yaar means friend, while yaari means friendship. Fropper, we guess is where everyone hops to make friends and connect.

The significant point here is that all three sites are Indian. That is not to say that you cannot interact with people from other countries. People from all over the globe subscribe to these sites. Check out these sites and see for yourself. Moreover, these sites offer as much as international sites in terms of services, if not more. In fact, when we started out research for this chapter, we did not expect these sites to be as popular as Orkut, MySpace or Facebook. What we see, however, is that these sites are as much a rage as international online social networking sites, and offer the same in terms of quality of service as well. You can expect the same promptness you get from Orkut or MySpace or Facebook, from these sites as well. Moreover, these sites have that distinct Indian feel to them, which you will relish once you start using them.

Sign up for any one of these services and you go through the now familiar procedure of receiving an activation link, which you need to click in order to activate your account. Fropper and BigAdda have something called themes for you. This specifies the layout of the pages that you see in your adda in BigAdda and your zone in Fropper—that’s right, your space is called a zone in Fropper. In addition, Fropper has a separate section called relationships. In this section you can meet people and connect with your buddies. In Fropper, you cannot send messages to people unless you create your relationship section within your zone. This also needs to have a different username from your zone username. Fropper, thus, seeks to segregate your space or zone from your friends, which gives you greater privacy on the site.